MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION MARCH 2025

SECOND SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) –

MG2DSCJMC100, MG2DSCPJM101- NEWS EDITING

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS) **QP CODE: 25900122**

Duration: 2 Hours Maximum Marks: 70

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse (An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I)and Appreciation (Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Multiple Choice Questions, Answer all questions Each question carries 1 mark

1. b) Proofreading

(Proofreading is the last step before publishing to catch typos and minor errors.)

[K] / [CO1]

2. a) The central space where news is gathered and edited

[U] / [CO2]

3. c) Because they control what information reaches the public

[K] / [CO2, CO3, CO4]

4. a) The ability of a news story to attract attention and be relevant to readers

[U] / [CO1, CO2]

5. d) All of the above

(Tight deadlines, unverified sources, and technical errors all affect copy quality.)

[K] / [CO3]

6. a) Verbosity

[U] / [CO2, CO3, CO4]

7. c) 9/11 Attacks

[K] / [CO3]

8. b) Pie charts, icons, and minimal text

[U] / [CO3]

9. a) Connect with the community

[K] / [CO2, CO3]

10. a) Press Council of India

[U] / [CO2, CO3, CO4]

Part B

Short Answer Type Questions (100 Words) , Answer any 10 questions

Each question carries 3 marks.

11. Verifying sources in news editing is crucial to ensure the accuracy, credibility, and reliability of the information being published. It helps prevent the spread of misinformation and maintains the trust of the audience in the media outlet.

[K] / [CO1, CO2,CO3]

12. A wire editor is responsible for selecting, editing, and organizing news stories received from news agencies (wire services) to fit the publication's style and relevance. They ensure the content is accurate, timely, and suitable for the target audience before it is published or broadcast [U] / [CO2, CO3]

13. A style book provides standardized guidelines on grammar, punctuation, terminology, and formatting, ensuring uniformity across all news content. This consistency enhances readability and upholds the professionalism and credibility of the news organization.

[K] / [CO1, CO2]

14. The key principles of newspaper layout and design include balance, visual hierarchy, alignment, consistency, and readability to ensure that content is engaging, easy to navigate, and visually appealing to the reader. [U] / [CO2, CO3,CO4]

15. A news headline is a brief, attention-grabbing title placed at the beginning of a news article to summarize its main idea. It serves to attract readers while giving them a clear idea of what the story is about. A good headline is accurate, concise, engaging, written in active voice, and often uses present tense to create a sense of immediacy. [K] / [CO1, CO2]

16. Feature stories are in-depth articles that focus on human interest, background information, or narrative storytelling, often exploring a topic with more detail and creativity. Unlike hard news, which prioritizes timely, factual reporting on current events, feature stories are less time-sensitive and allow for a more descriptive and emotional tone. They aim to inform, entertain, or inspire rather than simply report immediate facts.

[U] / [CO2, CO3,CO4]

17. Fairness to diverse views means presenting multiple perspectives, but it doesn't require giving equal weight to misinformation or harmful ideologies. Recent controversies, such as the coverage of climate change denial or extremist political rhetoric, highlight how some media outlets have confused balance with false equivalence. Responsible editorial judgment involves filtering out baseless claims while still ensuring fair representation of legitimate, fact-based viewpoints. [K] / [CO2, CO3,CO4]

18. Editorial decision-making is a structured and collaborative process involving editors, reporters, and sometimes legal or subject-matter experts to ensure accuracy, relevance, and ethical standards. Decisions are made through editorial meetings, discussions, and reviews that weigh news value, audience interest, and potential impact. This teamwork helps maintain journalistic integrity and aligns the publication's content with its editorial policies. [U] / [CO2, CO3,CO4]

19. Editorial cartoons use satire by exaggerating characters, situations, or events to highlight the absurdities and contradictions in current issues. Through humor, irony, and symbolism, they offer sharp commentary on politics, society, and public figures. These cartoons often provoke thought and debate, making complex topics more accessible to a wide audience. By blending art with

critique, editorial cartoons can challenge authority and influence public opinion in a visually impactful way. [K] / [CO2, CO3]

20. When handling copies from correspondents and freelancers, it's important to ensure that the content meets the publication's editorial standards for accuracy, tone, and style. Editors should verify the sources and facts provided to avoid misinformation and maintain credibility. Additionally, clear communication regarding deadlines, payment, and rights ensures smooth collaboration and respects the professional relationships with contributors. [U] / [CO2, CO3,CO4]

21. A hard news story typically includes the headline, which grabs attention, and the lede, which presents the most important information, answering the key questions of who, what, when, where, why, and how. The body follows with supporting details, facts, quotes, and context to elaborate on the lede, ensuring the reader understands the full scope of the event. Attribution is crucial, as it credits sources and ensures credibility, while maintaining objectivity and accuracy throughout the story. [K] / [CO2, CO3]

22. Political columnists should maintain objectivity and fairness, presenting facts and opinions in a way that respects all viewpoints, even when expressing personal views. They must avoid conflicts of interest, such as promoting personal political agendas or benefiting from affiliations that could bias their writing. Additionally, columnists should ensure accuracy, avoiding misinformation, and should be transparent about sources and their potential biases to uphold credibility and trust with readers. [U] / [CO2, CO3,CO4]

[3x10 = 30]

Part C

Essay Type Questions (450 Words), Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks

23. Typography plays a crucial role in the readability of a layout by influencing how easily the text can be read and understood. The choice of font style, size, and spacing affects the flow of information and can either enhance or hinder comprehension. Clear, legible fonts with appropriate line spacing and contrast between text and background improve the reader's experience and prevent fatigue. Additionally, the strategic use of typography helps create a visual hierarchy, guiding the reader's attention to key elements in the layout.

[An] / [CO3, CO4]

24. Video editing enhances storytelling in television programs by allowing for the precise arrangement of footage to build a coherent narrative. It enables the editor to control pacing, creating moments of tension, relief, or drama that align with the story's emotional arc. Through the use of transitions, visual effects, and sound, video editing adds depth and clarity to the storyline, making it more engaging for viewers. Additionally, editing helps remove unnecessary content, ensuring the program flows smoothly and maintains audience interest from start to finish. [U] / [CO2, CO3)

25. The layout of a traditional broadsheet newspaper is larger in size, with a more formal, structured design, often featuring multiple columns, dense text, and a clear separation between news sections. It typically uses smaller font sizes and focuses on in-depth coverage of national and international issues, with less emphasis on visual elements. In contrast, a tabloid is smaller and more compact, with larger images, bold headlines, and a more sensationalized approach to stories, often focusing on celebrity, entertainment, and scandal. The design of a tabloid is more visually dynamic, with a greater emphasis on grabbing attention through striking layouts and engaging visuals. [U] / [CO1, CO2)

26. Top editorial executives in a news medium, such as the editor-in-chief and managing editors, play a critical role in overseeing the overall editorial direction and strategy. They are responsible for setting editorial policies, ensuring the accuracy and quality of content, and making decisions about story selection and coverage. These executives manage the editorial team, coordinate across departments, and make final judgments on sensitive or controversial issues, all while maintaining journalistic integrity. They also represent the news organization publicly, shaping its reputation and credibility in the media landscape. [U] / [CO2, CO3,CO4]

[15x2 = 30]